

Build a Local AI Agent Without Getting *Fooled*

Spec your own local stack, catch the silent failures before they ship, and draw a hard line between what to hand off and what stays yours.

NAME

DATE

WEEKLY LOCAL CALLS

1 Spec Your Local Stack

- Pick your **local model** — check quant size against your RAM before committing.
- List the *only* tool-calls it gets on day one: file listing, `SELECT`, CSV grep.
- Nothing else. **Read-only first** is the whole rule.

```
model: _____ quant: ____ RAM: ____GB
tools allowed: list_files() | SELECT only | grep_csv()
```

STACK LOCKED

2 Find Your Own Null-Signup Bug

- Pick one table you own with nullable **date** or **category** columns.
- Ask: if every null row vanished right now, what *business meaning* dies with it?
- Write the one-line reclassification that turns the null into `signal`, not deletion.

```
df["____"] = df["____"].isna().map({True: "____", False: "____"})
```

NULL FOUND

3 Draw Your Reliable vs Can't-Touch Line

- List **5 tasks** you'd hand to a local agent.
- Mark `Reliable` only if you can verify it in under 10 seconds.
- Mark *Can't touch* if it needs judgment about **why** a number moved.

5 TASKS SORTED

4 Cost the Cloud-vs-Local Tradeoff

- Estimate your **weekly cleanup/profiling calls** if run locally.
- Multiply by your current *API per-call cost*.
- Compare against hardware you already own — `real unlock` or just a vibe?

```
calls/week: ____ x $/call: ____ = $____/mo saved
```

MATH DONE

5 Write the Escalation Sentence

- Pick a metric your agent tracks **weekly**.
- Name the external event — *pricing change, upstream schema shift* — that could make the raw delta misleading.
- Write the one `pushback sentence` a junior should say before anyone celebrates the number.

SENTENCE WRITTEN